Below the EU average?

A sentence in the Commission's 2026 Country Report, tested against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

> ***"58% of people in Malta reported never using public transport, below the EU average of 50.6%."***

European Commission, 2026 Country Report for Malta, 3 June 2026

Annex 8 (transport), citing a Eurostat news article.

Eurostat's survey of people aged 16 and over, 2024.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Figures close; "below" should read "above".

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

50.6%

EU figure is exact

Eurostat: 50.6% of people in the EU never used public transport.

58.6%

Malta's share

Eurostat's table now shows 58.6%; the report says 58%.

+8.0

Above, not below

Malta is 8.0 points above the EU average.

7th

Of 27 states

Tied with Croatia; six states have a higher share of non-users.

FAIR TO SAY

The substance holds: Malta has more people who never use public transport than the EU average. One word reverses the comparison. This check does not assess Malta's transport policy.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ The table version that gives Malta as 58%.
- ☐ The survey question behind "never".
- ☐ Before-and-after data on the free-fare scheme.